CELPIP EXPRESS

Reading Test

STUDY MATERIALS - 5

PART 1

Read the following message.

Dear Maggie and Alex,

I saw the news about the terrible storm and flood that hit Spiritwood last week. I was relieved when I received an email from you. It was good to learn that you are both okay but unfortunate to hear that your house was damaged. Still, you were lucky that there were only some broken windows and a little flooding in a few rooms. We realize that many people were less fortunate. The news programs showed pictures of all the horrible destruction that the wind and heavy rains caused—the tragic loss of lives and homes, and the flooding of farmland.

Our hearts go out to the flood victims and, as you had requested, Peter and I have put together some relief packages for those who lost their homes and belongings in the storm. With the help of our neighbors, we have collected some basic supplies, blankets, clothing, canned food, and bottled water. A friend of ours, travelling in the direction of Spiritwood in a few days, has offered to drop off the packages. We are now discussing how we could organize a larger food and clothing drive and get the entire town of Gladstone involved. I'll be meeting with the mayor, Sarah Stanley, as soon as possible to discuss how to organize the relief effort.

Because of the doctor shortage in Gladstone, Peter and I have been working really long hours at the clinic lately. Otherwise, we could have provided our medical expertise to the flood victims. Still, our younger son James has volunteered with a group that will help clean up the flooded area. James is finishing his last semester of university next week, so he'll be flying out right after his classes end on Friday.

Please keep us informed of the evolving situation in Spiritwood. If there is anything you need, don't hesitate to ask. Since we all met in medical school, you have both been like family to Peter and I. We have a guest room that you are more than welcome to stay in for as long as you need to.

Our thoughts are with you both, as well as with all the people in the flood-devastated area.

Arlene

Choose the **best** option according to the information given in the message.

1. What is Arlene's job?
- ◯ a relief worker
- ◯ a volunteer
- ◯ a doctor
- ◯ a government officer

2. Arlene is _____
- ◯ asking the mayor of Spiritwood for help.
- ◯ renting her guest room to families in need.
- ◯ getting help from her community.
- ◯ training as an environmental clean-up expert.

3. Maggie and Alex's house _____
- ◯ received some minor damage.
- ◯ suffered damage to the guest room.
- ◯ was very badly damaged.
- ◯ was less damaged than their farm.

4. Arlene is _____
- ◯ planning to visit Maggie and Alex.
- ◯ concerned about Maggie and Alex's health.
- ◯ sending useful goods to Spiritwood.
- ◯ worried about James' well-being.

5. Arlene is writing to _____
- ◯ offer financial help to her friends.
- ◯ offer her sympathy and support.
- ◯ request assistance in her medical clinic.
- ◯ request donations for affected families.

6. Arlene and Peter's son will _____
- ◯ cut short his studies to help.
- ◯ deliver medical supplies.
- ◯ organize aid in Gladstone.
- ◯ travel to Spiritwood.

PART 1

Here is a response to the message. Complete the response by filling in the blanks.

Hi Arlene,

Thank you so much for your offer of 7. _____ . At the moment, though, I think we are okay. The government has been a tremendous help, having flown in food, supplies, and temporary shelters. Fortunately, we have been able to 8. _____ .

However, all of the roads in and out of town continue to be blocked, so, hopefully, the 9. _____ will still be able to make it through somehow. Considering the state of things here, I am lucky to even have a way to contact you. Amazingly, despite the disruption of many communication services, 10. _____ is still working.

Anyways, please tell James his 11. _____ most welcome. We need all the help we can get tackling this mess.

Maggie

7. ◯ building supplies
   ◯ medical supplies
   ◯ plane tickets to Gladstone
   ◯ a place to stay

8. ◯ rebuild our house
   ◯ stay in our own home
   ◯ repair the roof
   ◯ clear the broken trees

9. ◯ army personnel
   ◯ mayor
   ◯ medical team
   ◯ relief packages

10. ◯ our radio
    ◯ the internet
    ◯ the phone service
    ◯ the postal service

11. ◯ clothing donations are
    ◯ medical supplies are
    ◯ team of volunteers is
    ◯ university friends are

PART 2

TOMMY'S USED CARS

78 Highway 6, South Bay, Ontario
1-800-262-9999
Personalized Purchase Options Sheet for **LESLIE WINTERGREEN**
Prepared by Tommy Jones on July 16, 2016, tommy@tommys-used-cars.com

#1 $9,999
2009 model – only 50,000 km.!!

Driven as a weekend car only, this vehicle boasts both power brakes and power steering. It has been well-maintained by its previous owner, and provides excellent fuel efficiency. This is a manual transmission car. Its light-blue finish is unique to that year, making it a rare find!

#2 $14,999
2010 model – 71,000 km.

With summer on the way, you'll want to step into this sleek, air-conditioned sedan featuring an upgraded sound system. The additional rear speakers allow passengers to enjoy music, even during louder highway driving. This 5-speed automatic comes with power brakes and power steering. Safety features include front, rear, and side airbags.

#3 $12,999
2012 model – 19,000 km.

This hip hatchback has newly replaced brakes and a brand new muffler! Interior includes black leather seats. Comes with standard all-season tires, as well as winter tires. Need to take a trip to the furniture or home improvement store? The back seats fold down for increased cargo capacity.

#4 $8,999
1990 model – 150,000 km.

This vehicle's roomy interior will ensure you and your passengers get from A to B in ultimate comfort! The vinyl-coated seats can also be reclined in the back for those who want to stretch their legs. It comes with all-season tires (replaced in 2010) and new brakes.

Read the following email message about the diagram on the left. Complete the email by filling in the blanks

Subject: Purchase Options Sheet
To: Leslie Wintergreen <lwintergreen@mailmail.ca>
From: Tommy Jones
<tommy@tommys-used-cars.com>

Dear Leslie Wintergreen,

Thank you for visiting our lot yesterday. We are glad that you have chosen Tommy's for your used car purchase. I've researched our wide range of inventory and have created 1. _____ . Please see attached.

All the vehicles except the fourth one have
2. _____ , as indicated. All of the cars
3. _____ .

You mentioned that you wanted a car with
4. _____ , so I would recommend the vehicle pictured in the bottom right corner. Since you feel strongly about buying a car with very low mileage, I am also going to check my friend's lot on Monday to see what he has available. I will send you the details afterwards. 5. _____ , please let me know if you'd like to test drive any of these four cars this weekend.

Regards,

Tommy

1. ◯ a complete list of our cars
   ◯ a customized presentation
   ◯ an up-to-date weekly flyer
   ◯ an image from our web page

2. ◯ both all-season and winter tires
   ◯ newly replaced brakes and mufflers
   ◯ under a hundred thousand kilometres
   ◯ upgraded stereo sound systems

3. ◯ have automatic transmissions
   ◯ have air conditioning
   ◯ are 21st century models
   ◯ are going for under 15K

4. ◯ a set of winter tires
   ◯ fuel efficiency
   ◯ space for your family
   ◯ reclining front seats

5. ◯ Otherwise
   ◯ For this reason
   ◯ I repeat
   ◯ To sum up

PART 2

Choose the best option.

6. Tommy sent this email to _____

- ◯ arrange a test drive.
- ◯ introduce himself to a prospective buyer.
- ◯ provide information.
- ◯ sell Leslie Wintergreen a second vehicle.

7. Tommy and Leslie have probably _____

- ◯ never met.
- ◯ met once.
- ◯ chatted via the dealership's website.
- ◯ talked on the phone the previous day.

8. Tommy will most likely _____

- ◯ offer Leslie a special loyalty discount.
- ◯ call Leslie with more options.
- ◯ email Leslie again in a few days.
- ◯ refer Leslie to his friend's car lot.

PART 3

Read the following passage.

A. Situated in Lake Nicaragua, Ometepe is a mystical and fascinating island. Its name means "two mountains" in the local Nahuatl language, appropriate since the island is made up of two volcanoes that are connected by a narrow strip of land. This haven is admired by both residents and tourists alike due to its rich history, archaeological background, landscapes, and biodiversity. Life on the island revolves around the two volcanoes, about which many enduring myths and legends have been told and passed from generation to generation.

B. Featuring two volcanoes, Concepcion and Maderas, Ometepe is the world's largest volcanic island located in fresh water. Concepcion, a perfectly symmetrical and cone-shaped volcano, dominates the northern half of the island. Larger than its counterpart, Concepcion is active and has erupted multiple times since the 1800s. Here one also finds the island's two most populated villages, Moyogalpa and Altagracia. On the southern part of the island is Maderas, no longer active and a popular spot for ecotourists with its lush rainforests, cloud forests, and a lagoon lake located in its crater.

C. Archaeological evidence suggests that Ometepe was first discovered by indigenous tribes from Mexico who were traveling south in search of a paradise described by prophets. The Nahua were the first to inhabit the island around 2000-500 BC, followed by numerous other tribes. For centuries, Ometepe was a refuge for various societies until it was discovered by pirates in the sixteenth century. The invaders pillaged the local settlements, stealing livestock, harvests, and possessions, thus forcing the inhabitants to move to higher ground. In the late 1500s, Spanish conquistadors colonized Ometepe, converting its residents to Catholicism. Even so, the locals incorporated many of their traditional customs and beliefs into Christianity currently celebrate more religious and folk festivals than any other part of Nicaragua.

D. The island's economy is fuelled primarily by agriculture, but tourism is also growing. The presence of volcanic ash makes the soil extremely fertile. Farmers can plant the fields continuously, without the need to leave them unseeded for a season. The main crop is plantains, although tobacco and coffee are also produced. Travel to the island has boomed in recent decades and the locals have become known for their warmth, hospitality, and love of the island. Due to rising interest in ecotourism, the majority of visitors go to appreciate the island's natural beauty; hiking is especially popular. However, other attractions abound. Ometepe is famous for its thousands of rock carvings and stone statues left by ancient civilizations.

E. Not given in any of the above paragraphs.

Decide which paragraph, A to D, has the information given in each statement below.

Select E if the information is not given in any of the paragraphs.

1. Transportation to Ometepe is very expensive.

○ A ○ B ○ C ○ D ○ E

2. Art produced by Ometepe's past cultures also draws visitors.

○ A ○ B ○ C ○ D ○ E

3. Locals have passed down traditional stories about the volcanoes through the ages.

○ A ○ B ○ C ○ D ○ E

4. The island was home to a succession of inhabitants over several millennia.

○ A ○ B ○ C ○ D ○ E

5. Ometepe's appearance is dominated by the two volcanoes.

○ A ○ B ○ C ○ D ○ E

6. Ometepe's inhabitants welcome sightseers.

○ A ○ B ○ C ○ D ○ E

7. Pirate invaders built new settlements in Altagracia.

○ A ○ B ○ C ○ D ○ E

8. Many inhabitants live on the north side of the island.

○ A ○ B ○ C ○ D ○ E

9. Celebrations in Ometepe have diverse historical origins.

○ A ○ B ○ C ○ D ○ E

PART 4

Read the following article from a website.

Every major drug company conducts extensive research and development to create brand name prescription medicines. In return, a government grants the pharmaceutical company a patent on a new drug, that is, the exclusive right to make and sell it. A patent is temporary, though. After it expires, other companies can copy the brand name drug, producing an inexpensive generic version having similar ingredients and benefits.

James Connaught represents the Pharmaceutical Manufacturers Alliance. "We actively lobby the government to endorse agreements that, once made law, would allow pharmaceutical companies to extend the duration of drug patent protections or even make them permanent," says Connaught. "In developing their products, pharmaceutical companies invest billions of dollars in exhaustive research and testing. Even products verified as safe sometimes incur lawsuits. To absorb all these costs, drug companies must stay profitable—so the government must strengthen patent laws."

Connaught considers generic drug makers akin to parasites. "They don't do research and development; they don't take the financial risks involved in launching new drugs; they don't innovate. They just skim off profits from other companies, without contributing anything of their own."

Heather Weiller of the Affordable Health Alliance (AHA), a consumer advocacy group, has a different perspective. "Big Pharma is a big rip-off. Medications are a necessity, not a luxury, so the government should ensure they're affordable—that is, friendly to generics. Even with generics nibbling at their profit margins, Big Pharma profits are still astronomical. Private health insurance companies know that, and won't reimburse consumers for brand names if there's a cheaper generic available. In that respect, generics are essential. Governments shouldn't collude with pharmaceutical companies to stall generics or keep them off the market. If anything, drug patent protections should be weakened."

In fact, Weiller credits generic drug makers for saving the lives of millions around the globe. "If not for generic drugs, the governments of some developing countries couldn't afford basic medications for their citizens at all. In effect, laws that hasten or at least preserve drug patent expiries assist the developing world."

Choose the **best** option according to the information given on the website.

1. The title that best conveys the article's main point is "Big Pharma Brands: How much _____

- ◯ globalization can they survive?"
- ◯ capital can they truly invest?"
- ◯ protection do they deserve?"
- ◯ research do they undertake?"

2. Strongly contrasted opinions on generics are presented in paragraphs _____

- ◯ one and three.
- ◯ two and three.
- ◯ three and five.
- ◯ four and five.

3. Connaught's remarks in paragraph two can be best summed up as _____

- ◯ "A fool and his money are soon parted."
- ◯ "Health is more important than wealth."
- ◯ "Don't put all your eggs in one basket."
- ◯ "He who pays the piper calls the tune."

4. Connaught's attitude toward generics is _____

- ◯ largely hostile.
- ◯ moderately critical.
- ◯ guardedly supportive.
- ◯ mildly optimistic.

5. If successful, the AHA's efforts will reduce _____

- ◯ government involvement in patent regulations.
- ◯ life expectancy in economically struggling nations.
- ◯ monopolistic tendencies among large drug firms.
- ◯ satisfaction among medical insurance companies.

PART 4

The following is a comment by a visitor to the website page. Complete the comment by choosing the best option to fill in each blank.

I understand what the author is saying—that drug patents are granted as a matter of 6. _____ . But that doesn't necessarily mean they're a good idea. Nor am I sure, as the author seems to think, that generics are as beneficial as brand name drugs.

Weiller is right to point out that the effect of generics on Big Pharma profits is 7. _____ . But I'm not so sure she's right when she implies that the decisions of private health insurance companies are motivated by 8. _____ .

Like the AHA, I'd welcome laws that would make 9. _____ . Furthermore, I'm all for supporting poorer nations and families, one 10. _____ at a time.

6. ◯ fairness
   ◯ tradition
   ◯ efficiency
   ◯ precaution

7. ◯ disturbing
   ◯ substantial
   ◯ negligible
   ◯ surprising

8. ◯ the well-being of their policy holders
   ◯ how much profit Big Pharma makes
   ◯ the efforts of consumer advocacy groups
   ◯ whether generics are sold in other countries

9. ◯ branded pharmaceuticals a thing of the past
   ◯ elected officials stop listening to pharma firms
   ◯ generics arrive sooner on pharmacy shelves
   ◯ insurance companies pay for brand name drugs

10. ◯ brand name
    ◯ generic recall
    ◯ insurance policy
    ◯ patent expiration

Answer Key

PART 1	
Question 1	a doctor
Question 2	getting help from her community.
Question 3	received some minor damage.
Question 4	sending useful goods to Spiritwood.
Question 5	offer her sympathy and support.
Question 6	travel to Spiritwood.
Question 7	a place to stay
Question 8	stay in our own home
Question 9	relief packages
Question 10	the internet
Question 11	team of volunteers is

PART 2	
Question 1	a customized presentation
Question 2	under a hundred thousand kilometres
Question 3	are going for under 15K
Question 4	space for your family
Question 5	Otherwise
Question 6	provide information.
Question 7	met once.
Question 8	email Leslie again in a few days.

PART 3	
Question 1	E
Question 2	D
Question 3	A
Question 4	C
Question 5	A
Question 6	D
Question 7	E
Question 8	B
Question 9	C

PART 4	
Question 1	protection do they deserve?"
Question 2	three and five.
Question 3	"He who pays the piper calls the tune."
Question 4	largely hostile.
Question 5	monopolistic tendencies among large drug firms.
Question 6	fairness
Question 7	negligible
Question 8	how much profit Big Pharma makes
Question 9	generics arrive sooner on pharmacy shelves
Question 10	patent expiration